

Interview Protocol

Successful African American professionals

Jim Pham

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Narrative research will be used to explore JA's life and determine which factors seem to influence the success of African American professionals. This research method is a storytelling of individual experiences. At the end of this study, I hope to gain a better understanding of what factors seem to influence JA's success in life and career. The interview protocol will be a 3-part series with JA and his family, including interviews, observations, photographs, and audio recordings.

Participant Demographic Information

Researcher: Jim Pham institution: Alliant International Univ.

Participant (initials): JA Pseudonym: John

1. Age: _____ Age Category: 18-25 _____ 25-32 _____ 32-39 _____ 40 and older _____

2. Ethnicity: A.A. Country of origin: U.S.

3. Years of Residence in the U.S.: _____ 1-3 _____ 3-6 _____ 6-9 _____ 10 or more _____

4. Marital Status: Single ___ Married ___ Cohabiting ___ Separated ___ Divorced ___ Widowed ___

5. Children (ages): _____

6. Years of formal education: Fewer than 8 ____ 9-11 ____ 12 or HS equiv. ____ 12-16 ____ 16+ ____

7. Employer: _____ Title of your position: _____ Year: _____

Observation:

Interview Record Form

Researcher: Jim Pham

Institution: AIU

Participant (initials): JA

Pseudonym: John

Site of Interview: _____

Date: _____ Time: _____

Audiotape: _____

Transcript #: _____

Observation:

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Interview Guide for Interview with John

Interview One: Background Information (Unstructured)

Researcher: __Jim Pham__

Institution: __AIU__

Participant (initials): __JA__

Pseudonym: __John__

Site of Interview: _____

Date: _____ Time: _____

Casual Conversation

1. What is your occupation?
2. What is your employer's name?
3. What do you do there?
4. How long have you been working for _____?
5. What is your job title?
6. What primary function does your job involve?
7. How do you describe the organization that you work for?

Growing up

1. What can you tell me about your learning experiences as you grew up?
2. How was it like for you to learn in school?
3. Was there a class or activity in school that you enjoyed or disliked in particular? Tell me about it.
4. What can you tell me about your relationships with peers, teachers, administrators, or family members that might have influenced your learning experiences in school?
5. What other aspects of your life were linked to your learning experience in school?
6. What can you tell me about your learning at home?
7. What other kinds of learning did you experience outside of school?
8. How were people or family members influential to your learning outside of school?

Early Adulthood

1. What kinds of learning did you experience when you left school?
2. How did family members or other people influence your learning at this time?
3. What other factors influenced your learning experiences? Can you recall any specific situations or circumstances that you may have contributed to either your participation or lack of involvement in learning as a young adult?
4. Is there anything else we should know about you?

***Interview Two: Family
(Semi-structured)***

Researcher: Jim Pham

Institution: AIU

Participant (initials): JA

Pseudonym: John

Site of Interview: _____

Date: _____ Time: _____

General Questions Relating to Family and Personal Views about Education

1. Are you married?
2. What is your spouse's name?
3. Do you have any kids? How many kids do you have?
4. Follow-up question: What do your kids like about school? What would your kid(s) like to be when they grow up? Where do your kids go to school (public or private)?
5. Did you go to college? What college did you go to? How many years did you spend in college? Did you graduate? Why did you decide to go to college? Who paid your way through school?
6. What is the educational level of your spouse?
7. What is the educational level of your father?
8. What is the educational level of your mother?
9. Do you have any siblings? How many brothers and sisters do you have? What is the educational level of your siblings?
10. What person influenced you to pursue education and a career?
11. What are your educational goals?
12. What are your beliefs about education?
13. Is there anything else about education that we have not talked about, but that you would like to share?

***Interview Three: Professionalism
(Structured)***

Researcher: __Jim Pham_____

Institution: __AIU_____

Participant (initials): __JA_____

Pseudonym: _John_____

Site of Interview: _____

Date: _____ Time: _____

General Questions Relating to Professionalism

1. What does someone have to do to be considered a professional in your view?
2. Do you believe education is a vehicle to advance a person's career and life?
3. Do you consider yourself successful (career and family)?
4. What are your thoughts and feelings about being a successful African American?
5. What challenge have you faced as an African American in school or work?
6. Did you have a role model in life? How did having a role model influence your professional success? With whom you can discuss important issues?
7. How has your career progressed to date? Have your expectations been met?
8. How do you see yourself five years from now?